

Validation Report

CSE211 - (Web Programming)

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Group 5:

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1. Introduction

W3C HTML Validation: Ensuring Standards Compliance

The World Wide Web Consortium (W3C) is the main international standards organization for the World Wide Web. W3C's mission is to develop protocols and guidelines that ensure the long term growth and accessibility of the Web. One of its most valuable tools for developers is the W3C Markup Validation Service, a free service that checks HTML and XHTML documents to W3C Recommendations and other standards.

Why Validation Matters

- HTML validation serves several purposes in web development:
- Cross browser Compatibility
- Accessibility Compliance
- Future-proofing
- Performance Optimization
- Professional Standards

For this Web Programming assignment, validation is a required task in Part 5.

2.Home Page (index.html)

Status: Error

Errors: 8

Warnings: 0

Screenshots:

- Error** The `width` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 34, column 9; to line 34, column 62
`<table width="100%" cellpadding="10">`
- Error** The `cellspacing` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 34, column 9; to line 34, column 62
`<table width="100%" cellpadding="10">`
- Error** The `cellpadding` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 34, column 9; to line 34, column 62
`<table width="100%" cellpadding="10">`
- Error** The `width` attribute on the `td` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 35, column 17; to line 36, column 45
`<td width="70%">`
- Error** The `valign` attribute on the `td` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 35, column 17; to line 36, column 45
`<td width="70%" valign="top">`
- Error** The `width` attribute on the `td` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 84, column 22; to line 85, column 45
`<td width="30%">`
- Error** The `valign` attribute on the `td` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 84, column 22; to line 85, column 45
`<td width="30%" valign="top">`
- Error** The `marquee` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 100, column 25; to line 100, column 68
`<marquee behavior="scroll" direction="left">Latest`

How We Addressed Them:

Issues:

W3C validator showed 8 errors for obsolete table attributes (width, cellspacing, cellpadding, valign) and <marquee> element.

Reason:

HTML5 Likes CSS for styling and presentation. These are used to separate structure from styling.

Alternatives Considered:

1. **Inline CSS:** Replace attributes with style.

Rejected Approach: Mixes styling with structure, against the assignment specifications to use HTML5-only.

2. **XHTML DOCTYPE:** Use older standards where attributes like these are common and allowed.

Rejected Approach: Violates HTML5 requirement and the purpose of the assignment. Not a modern practice.

Resolution:

- Left table attributes for layout in pure HTML (no CSS).
- Left marquee as is since it was a requirement for the assignment. Could be changed or addressed and replaced with a static <p> or use CSS.

Justification:

Assignment limits us to HTML5 semantics without CSS. Attributes enable layouts while maintaining structure. Left the rest of the warnings untouched until css is allowed- further notice.

3. About Us Page (about.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 0

Warnings: 0

Screenshots:

Showing results for about.html (checked with vnu 25.12.5)

Checker Input

Show ☒ source ☒ outline ☒ image report

Check by No file chosen

Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

Document checking completed. No errors or warnings to show.

Image report

4. Contact Us Page (contact.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 6

Warnings: 0

Screenshots:

1. **Error** The `border` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. Consider specifying `img { border: 0; }` in CSS instead.
[From line 53, column 13; to line 53, column 62](#)

```
<table border="1" cellspacing="0" cellpadding="5"></pre>
```
2. **Error** The `cellspacing` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
[From line 53, column 13; to line 53, column 62](#)

```
<table border="1" cellspacing="0" cellpadding="5"></pre>
```
3. **Error** The `cellpadding` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
[From line 53, column 13; to line 53, column 62](#)

```
<table border="1" cellspacing="0" cellpadding="5"></pre>
```
4. **Error** Element `a` not allowed as child of element `figure` in this context. (Suppressing further errors from this subtree.)
[From line 73, column 17; to line 73, column 84](#)

```
<a href="https://maps.app.goo.gl/enQc1UKb7hnbVT9p7" target="_blank">Click
```

Contexts in which element `a` may be used:

 - Where [phrasing content](#) is expected.

Content model for element `figure`:

 - Either: one [figcaption](#) element followed by [flow content](#).
 - Or: [flow content](#) followed by one [figcaption](#) element.
 - Or: [flow content](#).
5. **Error** No `p` element in scope but a `p` end tag seen.
[From line 73, column 122; to line 73, column 125](#)

```
e Maps</a></p></pre>
```
6. **Error** Element `p` not allowed as child of element `figure` in this context. (Suppressing further errors from this subtree.)
[From line 73, column 122; to line 73, column 125](#)

```
e Maps</a></p></pre>

Contexts in which element p may be used:


  - Where flow content is expected.
  - As a child of an hgroup element.

Content model for element figure:


  - Either: one figcaption element followed by flow content.
  - Or: flow content followed by one figcaption element.
```


How We Addressed Them

Issues:

W3C validator reported 6 errors mostly for obsolete attributes:

- Table attributes: border, cellspacing, cellpadding.
- Element a not allowed as child of element figure in this context.
- No p element in scope but a p end tag seen.
- Element p not allowed as child of element figure in this context.

Reason:

HTML5 Likes CSS for styling and presentation. These are used to separate structure from styling. For structural errors in figure, not allowed to add `<p>` or `<a>` in that way.

Alternatives Considered:

1. **Inline CSS:** for iframe.
 - Rejected: Mixes Structure with HTML, against assignment's HTML5-only focus.
2. **Older DOCTYPE:** Use XHTML to allow attributes.
 - Rejected: Violates HTML5 requirement, not modern.
3. **For figure errors:** Remove or wrap in a different way.

Resolution:

- Left table attributes for layout in pure HTML (no CSS).
- changed the iframe to not use border effect.
- since they aren't needed, all modern browsers support iframe.

Justification:

Assignment limits us to HTML5 semantics without CSS. Attributes enable layouts while maintaining structure. Left the rest of the warnings untouched until css is allowed- further notice.

After:

Checker Input

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Check by file upload No file chosen

Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

Message Filtering

- Error** The `cellspacing` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 53, column 13 to line 53, column 51
`<table cellspacing="0" cellpadding="5"></>`
- Error** The `cellpadding` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 53, column 13 to line 53, column 51
`<table cellspacing="0" cellpadding="5"></>`

5. Courses Catalog Page (course-catalog.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 33

Warnings: 0

Screenshots:

- Error** The `width` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 49, column 9 to line 49, column 62
`><table width="100%" cellspacing="20" cellpadding="10"></>`
- Error** The `cellspacing` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 49, column 9 to line 49, column 62
`><table width="100%" cellspacing="20" cellpadding="10"></>`
- Error** The `cellpadding` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 49, column 9 to line 49, column 62
`><table width="100%" cellspacing="20" cellpadding="10"></>`
- Error** The `width` attribute on the `td` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 50, column 17 to line 51, column 45
`<tr><td width="20%" valign="top"></td></tr>`
- Error** The `valign` attribute on the `td` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 50, column 17 to line 51, column 45
`<tr><td width="20%" valign="top"></td></tr>`
- Error** The `width` attribute on the `td` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 91, column 22 to line 92, column 45
`</td><td width="80%" valign="top"></td></tr>`
- Error** The `valign` attribute on the `td` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 91, column 22 to line 92, column 45

How We Addressed Them:

Issues:

W3C validator showed 33 errors for obsolete table attributes (width, cellspacing, cellpadding, valign, border).

Reason:

HTML5 prefers CSS for styling and presentation to maintain semantic structure. These attributes were used to create a readable, grid-like display of courses without CSS, as the page requires a tabular layout for the course catalog data.

Alternatives Considered:

1. **Inline CSS:** Replace attributes with style attributes

Rejected Approach: Mixes styling with structure, which is against the assignment's Specifications on semantic HTML5-only implementation.

2. **XHTML DOCTYPE:** Switch to an older version where these attributes are common, allowed and valid.

Rejected Approach: Contradicts the assignment's HTML5 requirement and modern web standards. It wouldn't go with the course's aim.

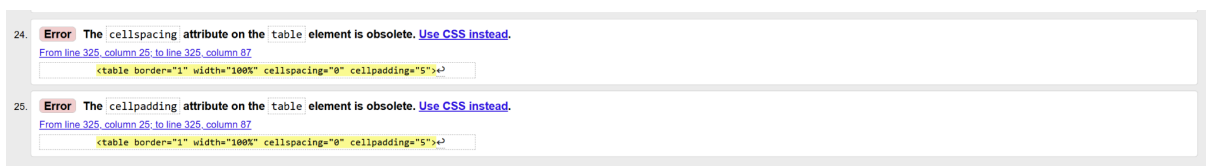
Resolution:

- Retained the table attributes for layout in pure HTML (no CSS), as they are necessary to achieve the required multi-column course display (33% width columns for balanced viewing) without breaking functionality.
- Removed all valign since most browsers default is top even without using it.

Justification:

Assignment limits us to HTML5 semantics without CSS. Attributes enable layouts while maintaining structure. Left the rest of the warnings untouched until css is allowed- further notice.

After:



(reduced-all are css related)

6. Course Details Sub-Page (course-detail.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 0

Warnings: 0

Screenshots:

Showing results for course-detail.html (checked with vnu 25.12.5)

Checker Input

Show ☒ source ☒ outline ☒ image report [Options...](#)

Check by [Choose File](#) No file chosen

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[Check](#)

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

[Message Filtering](#)

Document checking completed. No errors or warnings to show.

Image report

.....

7. Registration Page (registration.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 0

Warnings: 0

Screenshots:

Showing results for registration.html (checked with vnu 25.12.5)

Checker Input

Show ☒ source ☒ outline ☒ image report

Check by No file chosen

Uploaded files with .html or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

Document checking completed. No errors or warnings to show.

Image report

8.Privacy Page Placeholder (privacy.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 0

Warnings: 1

Screenshots:

Same with all other pages initially

Showing results for privacy.html (checked with vnu 25.12.5)

Checker Input

Show ☒ source ☒ outline ☒ image report

Check by No file chosen

Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

1. **Warning** The `navigation` role is unnecessary for element `nav`.
[From line 19, column 9; to line 19, column 84](#)
`<nav id="main-navigation" role="navigation" aria-label="Primary Navigation">`

How We Addressed Them:

Resolution:

- Removed role from navigation

After:

Showing results for privacy.html (checked with vnu 25.12.6)

Checker Input

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Check by No file chosen

Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see t

Document checking completed. No errors or warnings to show.

9. Terms Page Placeholder (terms.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 0

Warnings: 1

Screenshots:

Showing results for terms.html (checked with vnu 25.12.5)

Checker Input

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Check by No file chosen

Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

1. **Warning** The `navigation` role is unnecessary for element `nav`.
[From line 19, column 9; to line 19, column 84](#)
`><` `<nav id="main-navigation" role="navigation" aria-label="Primary Navigation"><`

How We Addressed Them:

Resolution:

10. Removed role from navigation

After:

Showing results for terms.html (checked with vnu 25.12.6)

Checker Input

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Check by No file chosen

Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see t

Document checking completed. No errors or warnings to show.

11. Students Dashboard (student-dashboard.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 8

Warnings: 0

Screenshots:

1. **Error** The `width` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 43, column 9, to line 43, column 62
`<table width="100%" cellpadding="20" cellspacing="10">`
2. **Error** The `cellspacing` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 43, column 9, to line 43, column 62
`<table width="100%" cellpadding="10" cellspacing="20">`
3. **Error** The `cellpadding` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 43, column 9, to line 43, column 62
`<table width="100%" cellpadding="10" cellspacing="20">`
4. **Error** The `width` attribute on the `td` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 44, column 17, to line 45, column 32
`<tr> <td width="70%">`
5. **Error** The `width` attribute on the `td` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 151, column 22, to line 152, column 32
`</td> <td width="30%">`
6. **Error** The `border` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. Consider specifying `img { border: 0; }` in CSS instead.
From line 172, column 29, to line 172, column 78
`<table border="1" cellpadding="5" cellspacing="0">`
7. **Error** The `cellspacing` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 172, column 29, to line 172, column 78
`<table border="1" cellpadding="5" cellspacing="0">`
8. **Error** The `cellpadding` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
From line 172, column 29, to line 172, column 78
`<table border="1" cellpadding="5" cellspacing="0">`

How We Addressed Them:

Issues:

W3C validator showed 33 errors for obsolete table attributes (width, cellspacing, cellpadding, border).

Reason:

HTML5 prefers CSS for styling and presentation to maintain semantic structure.

Alternatives Considered:

1. **Inline CSS:** Replace attributes with style attributes

Accepted for this once.

2. **XHTML DOCTYPE:** Switch to an older version where these attributes are common, allowed and valid.

Rejected Approach: Contradicts the assignment's HTML5 requirement and modern web standards. It wouldn't go with the course's aim.

Resolution:

- This time instead of retaining the table we used at first, we will do some minimalist inline css with div to show the side by side. More in the extra section.
- Removed all valign since most browsers default is top even without using it.

Justification:

Assignment limits us to HTML5 semantics without CSS. Attributes enable layouts while maintaining structure. Left the rest of the warnings untouched until css is allowed until further notice

After:

Showing results for student-dashboard.html (checked with vnu 25.12.6)

Checker Input

Show ☒ source ☒ outline ☒ image report [Options...](#)

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[Check](#)

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

[Message Filtering](#)

- Error** The `border` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. Consider specifying `img { border: 0; }` in CSS instead.
[From line 190, column 21; to line 190, column 106](#)
`<table border="1" cellspacing="0" cellpadding="5" aria-label="December 2025 Calendar"><`
- Error** The `cellspacing` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
[From line 190, column 21; to line 190, column 106](#)
`<table border="1" cellspacing="0" cellpadding="5" aria-label="December 2025 Calendar"><`
- Error** The `cellpadding` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. [Use CSS instead.](#)
[From line 190, column 21; to line 190, column 106](#)
`<table border="1" cellspacing="0" cellpadding="5" aria-label="December 2025 Calendar"><`

12. Thank You Page (thank.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 0

Warnings: 0

Screenshots:

Showing results for thank.html (checked with vnu 25.12.5)

Checker Input

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Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

[Check](#)

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

[Message Filtering](#)

Document checking completed. No errors or warnings to show.

Image report

13. Calculator Page (calculator.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 0

Warnings: 0

Screenshots:

Showing results for calculator.html (checked with vnu 25.12.5)

Checker Input

Show ☒ source ☒ outline ☒ image report

Check by No file chosen

Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

Document checking completed. No errors or warnings to show.

14. Calculator Results Sub-Page (calculator-result.html)

Status: Valid HTML5

Errors: 0

Warnings: 0

Screenshots:

Showing results for calculator-result.html (checked with vnu 25.12.5)

Checker Input

Show ☒ source ☒ outline ☒ image report

Check by No file chosen

Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

Document checking completed. No errors or warnings to show.

15. Extra Notes and Documentation

- a. All pages were marked with 1 warning at the beginning of making the assignment “Role Navigation isn't necessary for nav”. It is a requirement in the assignment, but removing it doesn't affect anything. So it was removed earlier in the first stages of the assignment.
- b. Marquee element isn't really necessary but its solution is either using static `<p>` or using css, and since it's a requirement we left it since the actual good solution is using css, which we can't do yet.
- c. ***Important** after searching for solutions and methods for splitting columns or multigrid layout, we concluded that there are 3 ways to do so.
 - Option 1 is to use Tables, this method is obsolete according to HTML5 standards. It's the “Traditional” method. Since the assignment seems to try and restrict us to html5 only without css or js yet, this is the method we followed for most of the pages.
 - Option 2 is to use Divs with Inline CSS. This method is the now standard and common way, and the only valid one now according to w3c. To divide styling and presentation in CSS from structures in HTML5. This is the method we didn't want to follow since the assignment restricted us to use html only, but we used this method in student dashboard to demonstrate it and since the requirement clearly states using div elements for mutli-grid. This method is the “Modern” way, and shall be the method we use onwards after learning css fundamentals in this course.
 - Option 3 is divs without CSS using span. This method is very “Limited” and doesn't actually provide side by side structure that is needed for things like grid or splitting columns. Its very unsemantic as well.

With the help of many online courses stating the difference between all, we finalized this version of code. Demonstrating our understanding of all errors and solutions to these problems, but due to limited options of the assignment, maybe not reaching best website structure. But this issue will be solved in the future when we learn more.

16. Conclusion

The validation errors identified related to table layout attributes and presentational elements mark an important part of web development: the separation between structure (HTML) and presentation styles (CSS).

Why These Errors Remain Unresolved

We maintained certain "obsolete" attributes (width, cellpadding, border) in our Assignment for three reasons:

1. Assignment Constraints: The Assignment specifications required HTML5 implementation without CSS
2. This foundational assignment focuses on semantic structure before introducing styling in next lectures hopefully
3. Necessity: Without CSS, these attributes provide the only ways to create structured layouts as required

When we learn CSS in upcoming lectures, all the table based layout attributes flagged in this validation report can be easily replaced with modern CSS techniques.

Final Reflection

This validation report demonstrates that while our current HTML only Assignment meets assignment requirements for semantic structure and accessibility, it also shows the path in web development. The "errors" identified are not failures but actually they show exactly where CSS will enhance and make our work modern.

– AI was used in this Report to generate an introduction and conclusion.